

Tools, Platforms and Prompt Engineering

The Gen AI tools people actually use at work, how to write instructions that get good results, and how to connect AI to a process without writing code.

Platforms & Tools

Prompt Engineering

APIs

No-Code

What we will cover

Half theory, half practical. The prompt section is the part you will use tomorrow.

01 The tool landscape

How to sort dozens of tools into a simple map

02 Six tools up close

Numerous AI, Jasper, Midjourney, VEO, ODOU, Canva AI

03 Choosing a tool

Four questions before you buy anything

04 Prompt engineering

What it is and why the same tool gives some people better results

05 The prompt recipe

Five parts that turn a vague ask into a clear one

06 Types of prompts

Zero-shot, few-shot, role, chain-of-thought and more

07 APIs explained simply

How AI gets built into real products

08 No-code automation

Building useful things with zero programming

01

Platforms and Tools

There are thousands. You only need a map.

Sort every Gen AI tool by what it produces

Start from the output you want. The tool choice follows from that.

Text and writing

Emails, blogs, reports, summaries.
ChatGPT, Claude, Jasper, Copilot.

Images and design

Posters, mockups, social posts.
Midjourney, Canva AI, Firefly.

Video

Clips, ads, explainers, edits.
VEO, Runway, Synthesia.

Audio and voice

Voiceovers, music, dubbing.
ElevenLabs, Suno, ODOU.

Data and spreadsheets

Clean, classify, analyse rows.
Numerous AI, Copilot in Excel.

Code and automation

Write code, connect systems.
GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Zapier.

Writing, data and images

Numerous AI

Brings AI into Excel and Google Sheets. Drag a formula down and it categorises products, cleans messy text or writes descriptions for every row.

Best for: bulk work on lists and data.

Jasper

A writing platform built for marketing teams. Keeps a brand voice, uses templates for ads and emails, and works across a whole campaign.

Best for: consistent marketing copy at volume.

Midjourney

Turns a written description into high-quality images. Strong on style, mood and art direction.

Best for: concepts, moodboards and visuals without a photoshoot.

Video, audio and everyday design

VEO

Google's video generation model. Describe a scene and it produces short video with motion, camera movement and matching sound.

Best for: quick concept videos and social clips.

ODOU

Audio generation. Turn a written brief into a voiceover, jingle or background track, in many languages and voices.

Best for: narration and sound without a studio.

Canva AI

AI built into a design tool everyone can already use. Generates layouts, rewrites text, removes backgrounds and resizes for every channel.

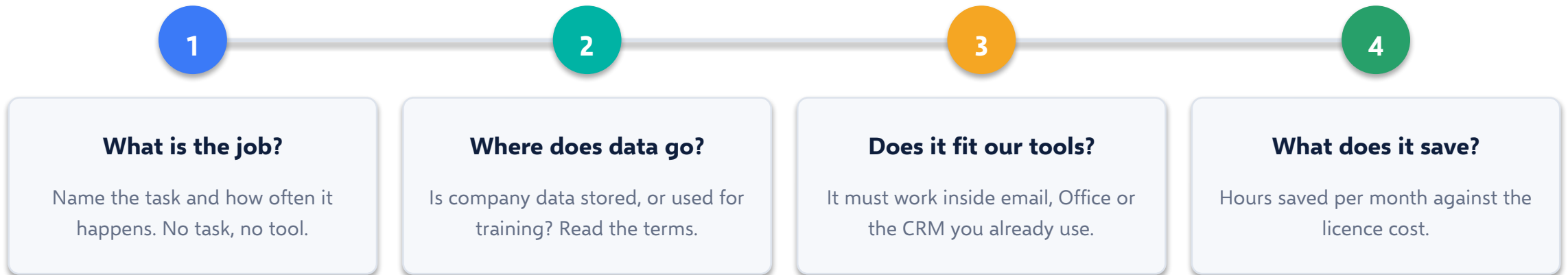
Best for: non-designers who need presentable output fast.

One table, six tools

Tool	What it makes	Use it for	Watch out for
Numerous AI	Spreadsheet output	Sorting and cleaning thousands of rows	Sending private data to the cloud
Jasper	Marketing text	Campaigns that must sound the same	Generic copy if the brief is thin
Midjourney	Images	Concepts, moodboards, visuals	Rights and usage for commercial work
VEO	Short video	Ideas, pitches, social clips	Small errors in faces and text
ODOU	Voice and music	Narration, jingles, dubbing	Consent before cloning any voice
Canva AI	Ready-made designs	Fast, presentable everyday design	Everything can start to look alike

No tool does everything well. Most teams end up using three or four.

Four questions before you buy any AI tool



A tool nobody opens after week two is not a saving. Adoption is the real test.

02

Prompt Engineering

Same tool, very different results. Here is why.

DEFINITION

Prompt engineering

The skill of writing instructions that get the output you actually wanted, first time.

- A prompt is simply the instruction you give the AI
- The model cannot read your mind or your context
- Vague in, vague out - every single time
- Small changes in wording change the result a lot
- It is a communication skill, not a coding skill

Not a technical job

If you can brief a new intern clearly, you can write a good prompt.

It is now a work skill

Job ads list it. It saves hours every week in any role.

It is trial and error

Nobody gets it perfect first time. Good prompts get edited.

The same tool, two very different results

The model did not get smarter. The instruction did.

WEAK PROMPT

"Write about our new product."

- No audience, so it guesses
- No length, so it rambles
- No tone, so it sounds generic
- No facts, so it may invent them
- Result: you rewrite the whole thing

STRONG PROMPT

"You are a B2B copywriter. Write a 120-word LinkedIn post..."

- Audience named: operations managers
- Length fixed: 120 words
- Tone set: clear, no hype
- Facts supplied: three key features
- Result: usable after a light edit

IN SHORT Every minute spent on the prompt saves ten minutes of rewriting.

Five parts of a good prompt

Miss a part and the model fills the gap with a guess.

1. Role

Tell it who to be.
"You are a financial analyst."

2. Task

Say exactly what to do.
"Summarise this report."

3. Context

Give the background.
"For the board, who are non-technical."

4. Format

Describe the shape.
"Five bullets, under 15 words each."

5. Constraints

Set the limits.
"No jargon. Use only the data given."

How prompting actually works in practice

Prompting is a short loop, not a single shot.



The last step is the one companies skip. A shared prompt library is where the real time saving comes from.

Six patterns worth knowing

Match the pattern to the difficulty of the task.

Zero-shot

Just ask, no examples. Fast, fine for simple tasks.

Few-shot

Give two or three examples first. Best way to lock a format or style.

Role prompting

Assign an expert identity so the tone and depth match the job.

Chain of thought

Ask it to work through the steps. Better for reasoning and analysis.

Iterative

Start broad, then refine over several turns like a real conversation.

Template

A fill-in-the-blank prompt saved for a repeated task.

Prompting at work, by function

The same skill pays off in every department.

Everyday office work

- Summarise long email threads and reports
- Turn rough notes into clean minutes
- Draft replies you only need to check

Marketing and sales

- Campaign copy in one consistent voice
- Personalised outreach at scale
- Product descriptions for whole catalogues

Analysis and reporting

- Explain what a dataset is showing
- Draft the commentary around the numbers
- Convert findings into a board summary

Learning and support

- Explain a hard topic at a simpler level
- Build training material and quizzes
- Answer routine internal questions

Do this, not that

DO

Habits of people who get good output

- Say who the audience is
- Give the facts it should use
- Ask for a specific format and length
- Show an example of good work
- Ask for two options and pick one

AVOID

Habits that waste your time

- One-line prompts with no context
- Pasting confidential data into public tools
- Changing five things at once when refining
- Trusting names, numbers and quotes blindly
- Sending output out without reading it

IN SHORT Brief it like a colleague, then review it like an editor.

03

APIs and No-Code Tools

Moving from chatting with AI to building with it.

What is an API?

A doorway that lets one piece of software ask another to do a job.

- Your app sends a request: here is the text, summarise it
- The AI service sends an answer back in seconds
- No screen, no chat window - software talking to software
- You pay for what you use, usually per volume of text
- This is how AI gets built into real products

Chat window

One person, one question, one answer. Manual.

API

Thousands of requests a day, automatically, inside your own system.

Why care?

Chat helps a person. An API changes a whole process.

Build with code, or build with no code

Most organisations use both: no-code to prove the idea, API to scale it.

API ROUTE

A developer connects AI to your system

- Full control over behaviour and data
- Fits neatly into existing products
- Handles very large volumes
- Needs developers and testing time
- Best for customer-facing features

NO-CODE ROUTE

A business user assembles it visually

- Drag, drop and connect - no programming
- Working version in hours, not months
- Anyone in the team can maintain it
- Less flexible for unusual cases
- Best for internal workflows

IN SHORT Start no-code to prove it works. Move to an API when it matters.

What people build with, without programming

These are the tools behind most 'we automated it' stories.

Zapier / Make

Connect apps with triggers. 'When a form is submitted, summarise it and post to the team chat.'

Custom GPTs

Upload your own documents and get an assistant that answers only from them.

Microsoft Copilot Studio

Build assistants inside Teams and Office using company data.

Power Automate

Automate approvals and document flows across Microsoft tools.

n8n

Visual workflow builder for more complex, multi-step automations.

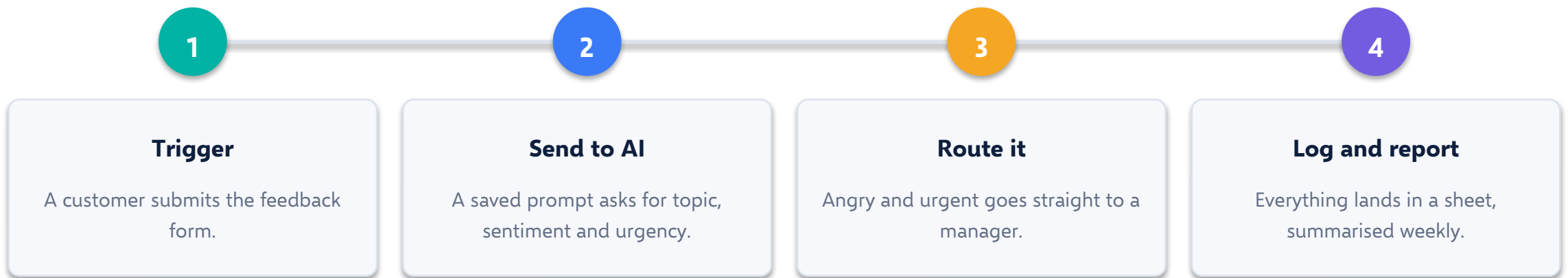
Notion / Airtable AI

AI columns and summaries directly inside the database your team already uses.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Automating customer feedback in four steps

Built in an afternoon with a form, a no-code tool and one good prompt.



Note the pattern: a trigger, a prompt, a decision, a record. Most useful automations look exactly like this.

Key takeaways

Unit 2 in six lines.

1

Choose the tool by the output you need

Text, image, video, audio, data or code. Start there.

2

Six tools, six different jobs

Numerous AI for data, Jasper for copy, Midjourney for images, VEO for video, ODOU for audio, Canva AI for design.

3

Prompting is briefing, not coding

Role, task, context, format, constraints.

4

Refine one thing at a time, then save the prompt

A shared prompt library is where teams gain real hours.

5

APIs put AI inside your systems

Chat helps one person; an API changes a whole process.

6

No-code lets you prove the idea this week

Build small, show value, then scale it properly.

UNIT 02 · TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGIES

Thank you

Next up — Unit 3: putting these tools to work in marketing, finance, HR and operations, and meeting AI agents.

QUESTIONS TO THINK ABOUT

- Which repeated task in your week could a saved prompt handle?
- Which tool would you trial first, and how would you measure it?
- What is the one workflow you would automate with no-code?